C-E-271J
June 25, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. C-E-00271H(Army-GL)
October 25, 1972 and
Fed. Spec. C-E-271F
July 16, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

EGGS, SHELL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers shell eggs which are the product of the domesticated chicken.

1.2 Classification (see 6.1).

1.2.1 Grades. Shell eggs shall be of the following grades, as specified:

Consumer grade:	Procurement grade:
Fresh Fancy Quality	I
AA	II
A	
B	

1.2.2 Conditions. Shell eggs shall be of the following conditions as specified:

Condition 1 - Fresh
Condition 2 - Shell protected, fresh

1.2.3 Weight classes. Weight classes for Consumer and Procurement Grade eggs shall be determined as provided for in the United States Department of Agriculture Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs and United States Standards, Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs.

FSC 8910

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-1163	-	Box, Corrugated Fiberboard, High Compression Strength, Weather-Resistant, Wax-Resin Impregnated

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-667	-	Sanitary Standards for Shell Egg Establishments

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(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Code of Federal Regulations (CFR), Title 21, Chapter 1
Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Copies may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture

United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers
Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs and United States Standards, Grades, and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs
List of Plants Operating Under USDA Poultry and Egg Grading and Egg Products Inspection Program

(Single copies may be obtained without charge from the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Marketing Service, Poultry Division, Washington, DC 20250.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Definition of quality. The quality of individual shell eggs shall be determined as provided for in the U.S. Department of Agriculture Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs and United States Standards, Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs. All eggs shall have been candled prior to offering and shall meet the requirements for grade, condition, and weight classes at time of offering for acceptance.

3.1.2 Cleaned shell eggs. Cleaned shell eggs may be accepted provided the eggs are cleaned as prescribed in the U.S. Department of Agriculture Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs and United States Standards, Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs.

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3.1.2.1 Consumer grade. Consumer grade eggs shall conform with Subpart C-United States Consumer Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs.

3.1.2.2 Procurement grade. Procurement grades shall conform with Subpart C-United States Procurement Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

3.3 Description of conditions.

3.3.1 Condition 1, fresh eggs. Condition 1, fresh eggs shall be eggs that are of current production. They shall not have been held in excess of 30 days and shall have been handled under temperature and humidity conditions which will maintain the quality of the eggs as described in USDA Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs. At time of delivery, the fresh eggs shall have a case average internal temperature not higher than 60°F. with no individual case having an internal egg temperature exceeding 65°F.

3.3.2 Condition 2, shell protected fresh eggs. Condition 2, fresh shell protected eggs, shall be fresh eggs meeting the requirements specified in 3.3.1 which have been properly treated by oils or other processing fluids (complying with the food additive provisions of 3.2) to afford protection to the quality of the egg in accordance with the USDA Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs. Delivery temperatures shall be as specified in 3.3.1. Eggs washed in a plant after being shell treated shall be shell treated again.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government.

4.2 Inspection certificate. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.1) the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Agriculture certifying that the grade of the product is as required in the contract or order.

4.3 Inspection.

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4.3.1 Inspection of marking, packing, packaging, weight classes, grade, condition, quantity and identity. Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of grading, packing and processing, at any suitable point in transit or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.3.2 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of containers for condition is performed by the USDA, the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. (For applicable criteria governing inspection of containers for the Military, see 4.3.8 and 4.3.9).

4.3.3 Plant qualification conditions (Military agencies). Award of contracts shall be limited to plants which have prior sanitary approval by the Military Veterinary Services in accordance with MIL-STD-667 or in plants as listed in the USDA publication titled "List of Plants Operating Under USDA Poultry and Egg Grading and Egg Products Inspection Program".

4.3.4 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated herein, or the Regulations Governing the Grading of Shell Eggs and United States Standards, Grades and Weight Classes for Shell Eggs, except as otherwise directed.

4.3.5 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 components and material shall be inspected in accordance with all the applicable requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.6 Examination of eggs (at origin). Compliance with specified requirements shall be deemed as having been met when each shipping container is identified by the appropriate USDA grade stamp, including certificate number, and the USDA grading certificate is furnished. At the time of grading, temperatures shall be taken on each shipping container graded. Failure to meet any of the referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot graded.

4.3.7 Examination of packaging. Examination shall be performed to determine compliance with packaging requirements of 5.1. The sample unit shall be 1 carton. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the sample unit and the sample size for inspection shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. Nonconformance to one or more of the referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.3.8 Examination of shipping container (level B). Examination of level B shipping containers shall be in accordance with table I. Examination criteria shall be as follows:

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs expressed in defects per hundred units	
				Major	Minor
I	S-3	One shipping container	Shipping containers	6.5	10.0

TABLE I. Level B shipping container

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Not style specified (see 5.2.1).
102		Dividers/liners not as specified (see 5.2.1.1).
103		Nomenclature missing, incorrect, or illegible.
104		Material imparts a foreign odor or flavor.
	201	Bottom closed with less than 12 stitches or stitches not placed as specified (see 5.2.1.2).
	202	Top flaps not glued with water-resistant adhesive applied throughout a minimum of 75 percent of the contact area.
	203	Strapping not type, class or finish specified (see 5.2.1.2).
	204	Strapping not placed as specified (see 5.2.1.2).
	205	Information other than nomenclature missing, incorrect or illegible.
	206	Not packed as specified (see 5.2.1.3).

4.3.9 Examination of shipping container (level C). Examination of level C shipping containers shall be in accordance with table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, lot size expressed in shipping containers and the sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. The AQL, expressed as defects per hundred units, shall be 10.0 for Minor defects.

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TABLE II. Level C shipping container

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Free edges or corners of flaps not securely fastened as specified (see 5.2.2).
202	Covers of fiberboard cases not sealed by sealing strips, staples or adhesive. (Applicable only when cases do not have self-locking devices which securely attach the cover.)
203	Flats, fillers or egg trays not new material, when specified.
204	Egg cases not new material, when specified.

4.3.10 Acceptance inspection for consumer or procurement grade eggs. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with requirements of 3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2 for grade and weight classes by acceptable candling and administrative procedures. Verification of inspection at origin shall be ascertained by examination of the official reports. Nonconformance to the above referenced requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Examination for temperature at time of delivery. Examination for temperature shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.3.1 and 3.3.2. The sample unit shall be 1 shipping container. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of the sample unit and the sample size for inspection shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. Finding of any temperature not in accordance with the specification requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.1 Examination for condition 1 or condition 2 at time of acceptance. Examination of condition 1 or condition 2 eggs shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.3.1 and 3.3.2. Verification of condition 1 or condition 2 shall be ascertained by examination of suppliers records and failure to supply such records shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5 Test methods. Test procedures and controls which differ from those specified herein, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the Government contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide as a minimum, such quality assurance, the supplier will use the test procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

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4.5.1 Test of fiberboard box. Test of fiberboard shall be in accordance with PPP-B-636 or PPP-B-1163, as applicable.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order (see 6.1), commercial packaging will be acceptable. When cartons are specified, they shall be new, standard, 2-by-6, commercial cartons, except that cartons with windows or openings are not acceptable. However, the carton may be perforated at the center crosswise to its length so that the carton may be separated into halves, each holding 6 eggs.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level B. Thirty dozen eggs shall be packed in a fiberboard box constructed in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s, of PPP-B-636. The box shall be furnished with a divider forming two internal compartments having dimensions of 11-3/4 inches by 11-3/4 inches by 13-1/8 inches (see Fig. 1). The divider shall be made of fiberboard complying with W5c of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, a wax-impregnated corrugated box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, class 1, type SWCFI, grade 250 of PPP-B-1163 may be used. The box shall be equipped with dividers as specified herein and shall have a hinged flap type hand hole cut in each end of the box (see Fig. 2). Closure, except as otherwise specified in 5.2.1, and interior packing material shall be in accordance with 5.2.1.2 and 5.2.1.3.

5.2.1.1 Dividers/liners. Each box shall be provided with 2 liners to form, when positioned in the box, 2 compartments. Each liner shall be fabricated and scored dimensionally to form 3 panels; the 2 end panels to be substantially the width of the box, and the center panel to have an outside length of half of the length of the box. The 2 liners shall be shaped into U sections and placed in the box so that the center portion of each liner is adjacent to side wall of the box and on opposite sides. The end sections are placed to form a double section in the center of the box and the other ends of the liners each form an additional thickness on the opposite ends of the box (see Fig. 1). The corrugations of the liners shall be vertical when placed in the box. The inside dimensions of the 2 compartments shall be 11-3/4 inches in length, 11-3/4 inches in width by 13-1/8 inches in depth; a tolerance of 1/16 inch will be allowed in any of the compartment dimensions.

5.2.1.2 Closure. The box shall be closed on the bottom with not less than 12 stitches, so placed that each inner flap is secured to the outer flaps by not less than 6 stitches. Two of these 6 stitches shall secure the overlapping sections to each inner flap. All stitches shall be placed at a maximum distance of 4 inches apart. The top flaps shall be glued with a water-resistant adhesive

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applied throughout not less than 75 percent of the contact area. The box shall be reinforced with 3 bands in accordance with the requirements of PPP-B-636. When pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape is used an overlap of 8" shall be required.

5.2.1.3 Interior packing. The fiberboard or other material used for interior packing shall contain no substance which will impart any odor or flavor to the eggs. The materials shall be new and not lower in quality than a good grade of newsboard. Fifteen dozen eggs shall be packed in each compartment in 5 tiers, 36 eggs per tier arranged 6-by-6. Each compartment shall be provided with 7 egg flats and 5 standard fillers. The standard egg flats shall be as specified in table III and the standard egg fillers shall be as specified in table IV. The fillers shall be positioned within the shipping case with solid part of the filler strip up and parallel to the center and ends of the case. Double flats, backs to back, at top or bottom shall be used regardless of net weight unless egg trays are used for interior packing. Alternatively, fifteen dozen eggs shall be packed in each compartment, in 6 tiers, 30 eggs per tier arranged 6-by-5. Each compartment shall be provided with 7 standard egg trays as specified in table V.

TABLE III. Requirements for egg flats

Outside dimensions:	
Minimum total	11-7/16 inches by 11-7/16 inches
Maximum	11-11/16 inches by 11-11/16 inches
Minimum weight of 14 flats	15 ounces
Number	36 (6 by 6)
Shape	Round or octagonal
Diameter at top of cup	1 inch
Depth of depression from rim to bottom	19/64 inch or 21/64 inch
Posts:	
Shape	Square
Length	3/16 inch

TABLE IV. Requirements for egg fillers

Minimum total outside dimensions	11-1/2 inches by 11-1/2 inches by 2-5/16 inches
Minimum total weight of 10 fillers	38 ounces
Dimensions of each cell, center to center	1-25/32 inches by 1-25/32 inches by 2-5/16 inches
Cells in filler	36 (6 by 6)
Length of filler tips	5/16 inch

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TABLE V. Requirements for egg trays

Recommended standard egg tray designation	A regular (chicken) egg tray
Minimum total outside dimensions	11-3/8 inches by 11-3/8 inches by 1-7/8 inches
Minimum weight of 14 trays	26 ounces

5.2.1.4 Eggs in cartons. Unless otherwise specified, eggs packaged in cartons shall be packed in the container specified in 5.2.1, except that the interior packing will not be required.

5.2.2 Level C. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) eggs shall be packed in new corrugated or solid fiberboard commercial 30-dozen or 15-dozen eggs cases with new, standard flats and fillers or egg trays. The tops of fiber cases shall be effectively sealed with adhesive, staples or sealing strips. Alternatively, when specified (see 6.1), the eggs may be packed in good used cases and packing material or a combination of new and good used. Eggs packaged in cartons shall be packed in the container specified except that interior packing will not be required.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Military agencies. In addition to the special markings required in 5.3.2 and any additional markings required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129, except that the net weight is not required.

5.3.2 Special markings. Marking shall include the designation "LARGE, MEDIUM or SMALL" as applicable for the size of eggs packed. Gross weight, cubic content, and arrow on side of case will not be shown on cases for domestic shipment. On the lid of the box the following shall be printed or stenciled in letters 1-inch high:

THIS SIDE UP

Cases for overseas shipment shall be marked on both sides with an arrow pointing to the top of the case. In addition, the level B fiberboard container shall have the following wording placed below "This Side Up" in letters one-inch high:

FOR OCEAN SHIPMENT

5.3.3 Civil agencies. In addition to the special markings required in 5.3.2, and any additional markings required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123.

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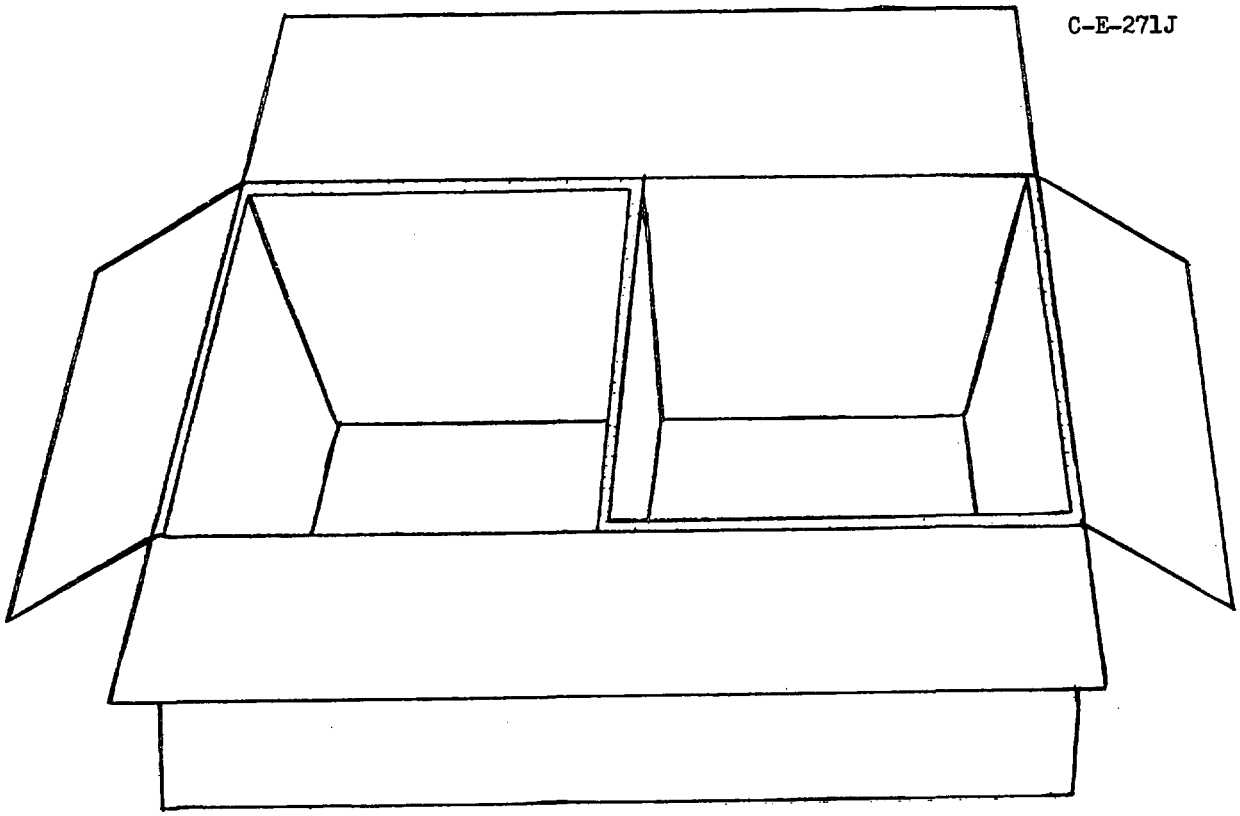


FIGURE 1 - Open box setup with corrugated dividers (see 5.2.1).

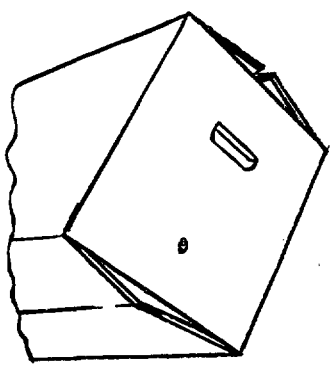


FIGURE 2 - Open box, style RSC (see 5.2.1).

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Grade, condition, and weight required (see 1.2).
(c) When a USDA official inspection certificate is not required (see 4.2).
(d) When other than commercial packaging is required (see 5.1).
(e) Levels of packing (see 5.2).
(f) When new cases and packing material are not required (see 5.2.2).
(g) When other than 30-dozen or 15-dozen egg cases are required (see 5.2.2).

6.2 This specification does not include all grades, conditions, and weights of eggs that are commercially available but is intended to cover the grades, classes, and weights that are normally suited for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 Destination inspection (For Civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for identity, condition and quantity only.

6.4 (For Military agencies). Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/ AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.14D/DSAR 4145.7, as applicable.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 45

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA - FSS
HEW - FDA, NIH
USDA - AMS
VA - DMS

Project No. 8910-0337

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

Eggs, Shell C-E-271J

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

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